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Privatisation of airports

Approved by the government in 2003

The idea of modernising Delhi and Mumbai airports was first considered by the Airport Authority of India (AAI) in 1996. In September 2003, the Centre approved a long-term lease by joint venture route with 74 per cent equity to a private consortium and 26 per cent with AAI. At present, airports at Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad and Kochi are managed under the public-private partnership (PPP) model. The Union Budget since 2016-17 has laid increased focus on the PPP mode in airport development that would eventually lead to a drastic reduction in logistics cost and pave the way for sustainable growth. In 2020, under the Aatmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan, the government had conducted an auction to privatise six more airports. In the second round of auctions, the government decided to privatise 13 airports. Recently, the Centre has unveiled its plans to privatise 25 airports over the next five years under the National Monetisation Pipeline.



ANI

Zojila Tunnel, J&K

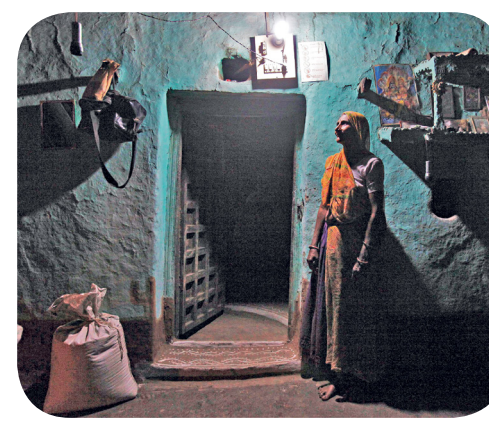
Last phase set to be completed in 2025

The 14.15 km-long Zojila tunnel is the first-of-its-kind tunnel project in the Himalayas, given the challenging geographical conditions. It will be the highest tunnel, at an altitude of 11,578 ft. It is also set to become the longest road tunnel in India and the longest bi-directional tunnel in Asia, providing all-weather connectivity between Srinagar and Leh via Dras and Kargil on the National Highway 1. The last phase of the construction works is expected to be completed in September 2025, ahead of its deadline of November 2026. Once the final tube of the project gets completed, the 32 km distance from Sonamarg to Minamarg will be covered in less than 40 minutes instead of four hours.

Electricity connections for all

Launched in 2017

The Pradhan Mantri Sahaj Bijli Har Ghar Yojana—Saubhagya, launched in September 2017—aims to provide electricity access to all households in rural as well as urban areas. There are about 40 million unelectrified households estimated in the country, of which about 10 million below-poverty line households in rural areas are already covered under sanctioned projects of Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Gram Jyoti Yojana. Thus, 30 million households are expected to be covered under the Saubhagya scheme at a cost of Rs 16,320 crore.



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